Scoring — Faan

Most tables have a **3-faan** minimum to win, with an upper limit of **13 faan**. Faan with different values in the same colored group do not stack – use the highest hand faan value. House rules vary.

Bonus & Situational

Self-Draw – *draw the winning tile from the wall*	1
Concealed – *no claimed discards except the winning tile*	1
Win on Last Tile – *win on the last tile of the wall*	1
Robbing the Kong – *win on a tile used to form a kong*	1
Win by Kong – *win on a replacement tile after a kong*	1
Win by Double Kong – *win on a tile from a kong, which itself was from a kong*	8
Heavenly Hand – *dealer wins on their initial 14-tile hand*	Limit
Earthly Hand – *win on dealer's first discard*	Limit

Flowers & Seasons

No Flowers – *no flower or season tiles*	1
Seat Flower – *flower matching your seat*	1
Seat Season – *season matching your seat*	1
Four Flowers – *have all four flowers*	2
Four Seasons – *have all four seasons*	2
Seven Robbing One – *seven flowers and seasons; can rob the remaining tile from another player when drawn; auto-win*	5
Eight Immortals Crossing the Sea – *eight flowers and seasons; auto-win*	Limit

Honors

Dragons – *dragon triplet or quad*	1 each
Seat Wind – *wind triplet or quad*	1
Round Wind – *wind triplet or quad*	1

All Hand Patterns

Chicken Hand — 0 faan
Mixed suits, sequences, and triplets



All Sequences — 1 faan
Four sequences and a pair



Half Flush — 3 faan
One suit plus honors



All Triplets — 3 faan
Four triplets/quads. Worth 10 faan if hand is concealed



Mixed Orphans — 1 faan
1s, 9s, and honors only



Seven Pairs — 4 faan
Seven unique pairs



Small Three Dragons — 5 faan
Two dragon triplets/quads and a dragon pair



Small Four Winds — 6 faan
Three wind triplets/quads and a wind pair



Full Flush — 7 faan
All one suit, no honors



Big Three Dragons — 8 faan
A triplet/quad of each dragon



All Terminals — 10 faan
Only 1s and 9s



All Honors — 10 faan
Only wind and dragon tiles



Thirteen Orphans — Limit
One of each terminal and honor, plus one duplicate



Big Four Winds — Limit
A triplet/quad of each wind, plus a pair



Nine Gates — Limit
One suit of 1112345678999 plus one. Must be concealed



Four Quads — Limit
Four kongs plus a pair





Lucky Cat Mahjong

Hong Kong Mahjong Guide

About Us

Lucky Cat Mahjong was founded in New York City by *Jorge Yau* and *Sophia Huang* in November 2025 with a simple goal: build a welcoming third-space mahjong community of strong players while honoring the rich heritage and traditional game of **Hong Kong Mahjong**. Every month, we organize **two free community events**: a large *community gathering* open to the public, and a mahjong *invitational tournament* to recognize and celebrate our most active and deserving members.

We specialize in organizing mahjong events and teaching *fundamentals*, *points*, and *strategy*. Every month we also collaborate with a handful of businesses and organizations to create unique experiences with mahjong events. Whether you're picking up tiles for the first time or looking to level up, our sessions will give you the skills and confidence to sit down at any table.

How to Get Involved

Support Our Cause

Our mission is to use mahjong as a powerful tool for building social connection and connecting with Asian culture by making it accessible to all. Our core values are **RICE**– Respect, Integrity, Community, and Empathy. Support us by buying merch, telling your friends, teaching beginners, and bringing mahjong sets to our free community events.

Volunteer

Volunteer at our events! We always need people to help greet attendees, teach newcomers, bring mahjong sets, and carry out event logistics. Our volunteers get free entry to paid events, and our most dedicated and consistent volunteers will be recognized on our website and get the opportunity to attend exclusive events.

SCAN FOR OUR ONLINE POINTS CALCULATOR

luckycatmahjong.com

Follow us on Instagram

@luckycat.mahjong

Setting Up & Basic Play

The Objective

Be the first to complete **four melds and one pair** (14 tiles), drawing from the wall or claiming discards. The minimum hand value to win is 3 faan.

The Tiles

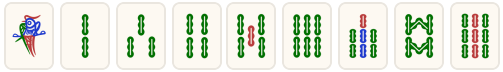
Characters



Circles



Bamboos



Honors



Flowers & Seasons

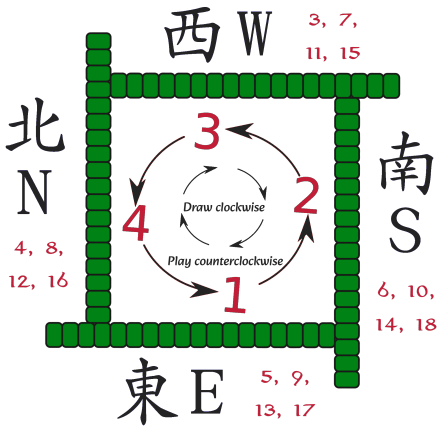


1. Build the Walls

Flip all 144 tiles face down and shuffle them. Builds four walls of **18 tiles long and 2 tiles high** (36 tiles each). Then push the walls closer together into a square.

2. Roll the Dice for the Break

The dealer (East) rolls three dice. Sum the total and go counter-clockwise that many times around the walls starting with East as 1 to determine which wall to break. Then count the same dice total from that wall going clockwise to make the break.



3. Deal the Tiles

Deal tiles in groups of four going counter-clockwise, while drawing clockwise until everyone has **13 tiles** and the dealer has **14 tiles**. Everyone draws replacement tiles from the end of the wall for revealing bonus tiles, starting with the dealer. The dealer starts by discarding a tile.

4. The Flow of Play

Take turns playing counter-clockwise (East → South → West → North). Draw clockwise from the wall. Between turns you may claim a discarded tile instead of drawing to complete a meld by exposing it. End your turn by discarding a tile.

Core Concepts

What Is a Meld?

A **meld** is a legal set of tiles that counts toward your winning hand. In Hong Kong mahjong you typically need **four melds plus one pair**. Melds can stay hidden in your hand (concealed) or be laid face-up after you claim a discarded tile (exposed).

The Melds



Chi Sequence

Three tiles in a consecutive run of one suit (e.g. 2-3-4 Characters). Only claimable from the player on your left.



Pung Triplet

Three identical tiles. You may claim a matching discard from any player. Has priority over a chi.



Kong Quad

Four identical tiles. Claim a discard to make an exposed kong, or declare a concealed kong or add it to an exposed meld when you draw the fourth yourself. After either, draw a replacement tile from the end of the wall. Has priority over a pung.



Pair The Eyes

Two identical tiles that complete the hand. Every winning hand needs exactly one pair.

Winning on the Last Tile

You can win by **self-drawing** the last tile you need from the wall, or by **claiming** that tile from anyone's discard. A win has the highest priority over chi, pung, and kong. If more than one player needs the same discard to win, the next player in the turn order wins.

Concealed vs. Exposed

A hand is **concealed** if you never claim a discard tile (except the winning tile). Concealed hands and self-draws earn bonus faan. Claiming discards **exposes** those melds face-up on the table for everyone to see. Once melds are exposed, they cannot be split apart.

Flowers & Seasons

Eight **bonus tiles**. They never form melds and are not part of your hand. Set them aside when drawn and take a replacement tile from the end of the wall.



Plum · Orchid · Chrysanthemum · Bamboo · Spring · Summer · Autumn · Winter